

Victoria T. Worley

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EDUCATION

University of Maryland | College Park, Maryland

- Ph.D. in Government and Politics Expected Dec 2026
 - Dissertation: "Vertical Litigation, Political Polarization, and State Attorneys General"
 - Committee: Prof. Patrick Wohlfarth (chair), Prof. Kristina Miler, Prof. Michael Hanmer, Prof. Matthew Green (Catholic University of America)
 - Subfields: American Politics and Methodology
- M.A. in Government and Politics May 2022
 - Subfields: American Politics and Methodology

Coastal Carolina University | Conway, South Carolina

- M.A.T. in Secondary Social Studies Education Aug 2019
 - Certifications: Secondary Social Studies Education Certification, Read2Succeed
- B.A. in Political Science, *Cum Laude* May 2018
 - Minor in Pre-Law

RESEARCH

Dissertation

- "Vertical Litigation, Political Polarization, and State Attorneys General"

Working Papers

- "The Hands that Bite: Federal Devolution, State Attorney General Power, and the Growth of Intergovernmental Litigation"
- "Delegation and Backlash: Federal Empowerment and the Rise of Intergovernmental Litigation"
- "Who Sues Whom? Intergovernmental Litigation in the United States During Polarized Times"
- "Variation in Citizens' Attention to the U.S. Supreme Court"

Research Interests

- Federalism; state attorneys general; vertical litigation; public law; judicial politics; state politics

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

University of Maryland, Department of Government and Politics

- Graduate Research Assistant Aug 2022 – Dec 2023
 - Project: Collecting case opinions from federal court judges
 - Supervisor: Prof. Patrick Wohlfarth
 - Focus: Judicial politics, judicial decision-making, judicial behavior
- Graduate Research Assistant Jun 2021 – Apr 2023
 - Project: Analyzing interest group involvement in redistricting litigation
 - Supervisors: Prof. Jim Gimpel and Prof. Patrick Wohlfarth
 - Focus: Interest groups, redistricting, litigation, judicial politics

ACADEMIC POSITIONS

Marymount University | Arlington, Virginia

- Adjunct Professor, *Department of History and Politics* Jan 2023 – May 2024
 - Courses taught: Theory of Democracy, Judicial Politics, Constitutional Law I
 - Nominated and shortlisted for the Robert A. Draghi Outstanding Faculty of the Year for the 2023-2024 AY

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor of Record

- CPJT250: Research Capstone, *University of Maryland* Spring 2025, Spring 2022, Spring 2021
- MLAW100: Justice and the Law, *University of Maryland* Fall 2024
- GVPT376/377: Experiential Internship Course, *University of Maryland* Spring 2024, Fall 2023
- POL210: Theory of Democracy, *Marymount University* Spring 2024
- POL330: Judicial Politics, *Marymount University* Fall 2023
- POL335: Constitutional Law I, *Marymount University* Spring 2023

Graduate Teaching Assistant

- MLAW100: Justice and the Law, *University of Maryland* Fall 2025, Fall 2021
- CPJT200: JLT Second-Year Colloquium, *University of Maryland* Fall 2025, Fall 2021, Fall 2020
- CPJT101: Food Justice in the DMV, *University of Maryland* Spring 2025, Spring 2022
- CPSP239: Teaching and Media Internship, *University of Maryland* Spring 2022
- MLAW105: Justice and the Law Service-Learning, *University of Maryland* Spring 2022
- CPJT100: JLT First-Year Colloquium, *University of Maryland* Fall 2021
- GVPT170: Introduction to American Government, *University of Maryland* Spring 2020, Fall 2019
- EDUC111: Exploring Teaching as a Profession, *Coastal Carolina University* Spring 2019, Fall 2018

AWARDS, HONORS, & FELLOWSHIPS

- UGST Graduate Student Staff Recognition Award (\$300), *University of Maryland* Apr 2026
Award for the graduate student employee whose exceptional service most contributes to Undergraduate Studies' academic community
- Conley H. Dillon Award (\$2,000), *University of Maryland* Jan 2026
Award for graduate student who makes an original contribution in the field(s) of intergovernmental relationships within the United States, American Government, or public policy in the United States
- Roger H. Davidson Award (\$500), *University of Maryland* Jan 2025
Award for the graduate student who writes the best paper in the field of American Politics
- Dissertation Grant (\$4,932), *Center for the Study of Federalism* Jun 2024
Grant to conduct in-person interviews with state Attorneys General and staff (returned as was no longer needed)
- Robert A. Draghi Outstanding Faculty of the Year (Shortlisted), *Marymount University* Apr 2024
Nominated and shortlisted for award that is presented by the graduating seniors to a faculty member who demonstrates teaching excellence, contributes to strengthening the overall university community and supports Marymount's mission
- Jean Elizabeth Spencer Award (\$11,000), *University of Maryland* Oct 2022
Award to an outstanding female graduate student in the Department of Government and Politics who demonstrates the potential to make a professional contribution in the areas of state and/or local government or American politics

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS & ACTIVITIES

Conferences, Workshops, and Invited Talks

- Annual Meeting of the American Political Science Association
 - Accepted for presentation: "Vertical Conflict in Court: Federal vs. State Suits in the United States" Sep 2026
- Annual Meeting of the Midwestern Political Science Association
 - Accepted for presentation: "Vertical Litigation, Political Polarization, and State Attorneys General" Apr 2026
 - "Variation in Citizens' Attention to the U.S. Supreme Court" Apr 2023
 - "Interest Group Activity and Redistricting Litigation in the United States" with Prof. Jim Gimpel, Tristan Hightower, and Prof. Patrick Wohlfarth Apr 2022
- American Politics Workshop, *University of Maryland*
 - "The Power and Role of State Attorneys General in Vertical Litigation" Oct 2025
 - "Variation in Citizens' Attention to the U.S. Supreme Court" Mar 2023

Professional Affiliations

- Southern Political Science Association Jun 2025 – Present
- Midwestern Political Science Association Oct 2021 – Present
- National Capital Area Political Science Association Aug 2020 – Present
- American Political Science Association Aug 2019 – Present

Professional Development

- Civic Engagement Across the Curriculum, *University of Maryland* Mar 2026 – Present
 - Professional development program designed to support the integration of civic engagement frameworks, best practices, and exercises into any course, regardless of discipline

CAMPUS ACTIVITIES

Graduate Student Government, *University of Maryland*

- Chair, Governance Committee Aug 2025 – Present
- Member, Governance Committee Aug 2019 – Present

Dean's Graduate Student Advisory Committee, *University of Maryland*

- Member, GROW Committee Aug 2020 – May 2022

**OTHER WORK
EXPERIENCE**

PredictIt | Washington, DC

- Social Media Manager

Jul 2025 – Present

Aristotle | Washington, DC

- Social Media Manager

May 2022 – Present